

closure_evidence_20260923

BOB-214 closure evidence — 2026-09-23

Defect

DANGER_ROOTS in scripts/pre_build_verification.sh never included the boba repository root itself — top-level files (13 first-party shell scripts including start.sh, the project's sole sanctioned container-control entry point, plus webui-bridge.py, a live HTTP service on port 7188) were invisible to the §11.4.252 fail-closed gate. The gate, unmodified, reports a REAL hit when pointed directly at webui-bridge.py: a except Exception: return False in _is_root_liveness_probe() silently swallows a malformed self.path parse failure.

Fix

1. constitution/scripts/gates/cm_dangerous_combination_fail_closed.sh gained a --max-depth <N> flag (+ DANGEROUS_COMBO_MAX_DEPTH env override), non-negative-integer validated (§11.4.201 — real condition asserted, not silently coerced).
2. scripts/pre_build_verification.sh's DANGER_ROOTS gained . (repo root), scanned at --max-depth 1 so it covers ONLY files directly at root — no redundant re-walk of the already-listed subdirectories, and no descent into constitution/, submodules/, node_modules/, .git/ (both the depth-1 bound and the gate's existing default exclude list keep it out).
3. webui-bridge.py's _is_root_liveness_probe() genuine finding fixed: the bare except Exception: return False now logs the diagnosable

anomaly before returning, mirroring the file's own existing [WebUI-Bridge] Upload error: {e} print-diagnostic convention.

Independent verification (coordinator, from clean shell)

Source spot-check

```
$ grep -n "max-depth\|MAX_DEPTH\|DANGEROUS_COMBO_MAX_DEPTH"
constitution/scripts/gates/cm_dangerous_combination_fail_closed.sh
[confirmed --max-depth flag + validation present]
$ git diff scripts/pre_build_verification.sh
[confirmed DANGER_ROOTS=(. download-proxy/src plugins scripts
qBitTorrent-go frontend/src cmd/boba-ctl),
max-depth 1 applied ONLY to "." entry via _dr_extra_args]
```

Independently-reproduced RED (pre-fix) → GREEN (post-fix), from a fresh

copy of each historical revision (not trusting the subagent's own report):

```
$ git show HEAD:webui-bridge.py > pre/webui-bridge.py    # pre-fix,
from git history
$ cp webui-bridge.py post/webui-bridge.py                # post-
fix, working tree
```

```
$ bash constitution/scripts/gates/
cm_dangerous_combination_fail_closed.sh --root pre --max-depth 1 >
pre_out.txt 2>&1
$ echo "PRE EXIT=$?"
PRE EXIT=1
# (line: "FAIL – silent default return (exception handler returns
a trivial
# literal with no re-raise/log) at .../pre/webui-bridge.py:550")

$ bash constitution/scripts/gates/
cm_dangerous_combination_fail_closed.sh --root post --max-depth 1
> post_out.txt 2>&1
$ echo "POST EXIT=$?"
POST EXIT=0
```

Note: an initial attempt piped both invocations through `| tail -15`, which silently reported tail's exit code (always 0) instead of the gate's — caught and corrected before trusting the result; re-run without the pipe gives the genuine PRE=1 / POST=0 split above.

Live root-scan re-run against the real (fixed) tree

```
$ bash constitution/scripts/gates/  
cm_dangerous_combination_fail_closed.sh --root . --max-depth 1 --  
quiet  
    CM-DANGEROUS-COMBINATION-FAIL-CLOSED: PASS – no swallowed-  
exception, silent-default-return or credential-default-to-literal  
anti-patterns found (§11.4.252)  
EXIT=0
```

Confirms no OTHER root-level first-party file introduces a new finding once in scope.

Advisory-only confirmed (invariant 39/56 does not newly block builds)

```
[39/56] CM-DANGEROUS-COMBINATION-FAIL-CLOSED: fail-open scan over  
first-party source (§11.4.252, ADVISORY)
```

Pre-existing framing (comment above the invariant, unmodified by this fix) confirms widening scope only reports more, never newly blocks.

Mutation suite (full re-run, independently)

```
    META OK:   L71 NEGATIVE CONTROL – a violation inside .git/  
stays excluded by the default exclude list (BOB-214) – gate  
correctly PASSEd on clean fixture  
    META OK:   L72 NEGATIVE CONTROL – a nested-only violation is  
invisible at --max-depth 1 (BOB-214, intended narrowing) – gate  
correctly PASSEd on clean fixture  
    META OK:   L73 a ROOT-LEVEL violation is still caught at --max-  
depth 1 (BOB-214) – gate correctly FAILEd on the mutation (rc=1)  
    META OK:   L74 --max-depth with a non-numeric value exits 2  
(argument error) (BOB-214)  
    META PASS ... META_EXIT=0
```

Status

Fixed. Closed by coordinator after independent re-verification — including a from-scratch reproduction of the RED→GREEN cycle, distinct from the subagent's own report.